```
List<String> menuHeadings = $(".main-navbar").find("li")
                                              .collect {it.text()}
```

Retrieve the text values for each main menu item. ❺

In ❶, you use a simple CSS selector to find and click on the search button. In the second example ❷, you check whether this search button is disabled. The next example ❸ will find any `<a>` elements nested inside a featured destination block. The fourth example ❹ uses a more complex CSS expression to identify and click on the link in the second featured destination block. The final example ❺ fetches all of the `<li>` elements in the main menu and converts them into a list of `String`s.

In Java, Thucydides provides its own support for fluent selectors. Though not as extensive as the Geb API, Thucydides still offers quite a few to choose from. The Thucydides equivalent of the Geb expressions shown above would look like this:

```
$("#search").click();
assertThat($("#search").isEnabled()).isFalse();
findAll(".featured-destination a");
$(".featured-destination:nth-child(2) a").click();
$(".main-navbar").thenFindAll("li"))
```

Click on the search button.

Verify that the search button is disabled.

Find all of the <a> elements inside featured destinations.

Click on the link in the second featured destination entry.

Retrieve a list of all of the main menu entries. ❶

Thucydides also provides a jQuery-like `$()` method, so many of the expressions look similar to the Geb equivalents. Java doesn't have closures, so in the last line ❶ you can use the LambdaJ library to do something similar.

When used well, fluent APIs like these are a boon to readability and expressiveness.

8.4 Summary

In this chapter you learned to automate UI tests for web-based applications:

- Automated web tests are a powerful testing tool, but one that should be used sparingly in order to avoid slowing down your test suite too much.
- The WebDriver API provides a rich and robust foundation for automated web testing.
- The Page Objects pattern can make your web tests cleaner and easier to maintain.
- Libraries, such as Thucydides, Watir, WatiN, and Geb, build on and extend WebDriver with additional features.

In the next chapter we'll focus on techniques for testing the non-UI layers of the application.